THE PROMPT + WHAT EACH MODEL COST

Is Claude Fable 5.2 *worth double?*

One prompt, two models, one try each in Claude Code. The exact prompt, the time and cost of each run, and when the pricier model earns its price.



OPUS 5.5 · $1.51 · FABLE 5.2 · $3.70

THE TEST

Same job, *two models*

Claude Fable 5.2 came out on 9 Nov 2026 and costs twice as much per token as Opus 5.5. So I gave both the same real job: a website for a small design studio.

How I ran it

- **Claude Code**, one prompt, **one try each**. No follow-ups, no fixes.
- **Opus 5.5 worked by itself.** No skills: I blocked them for this run.
- **Fable 5.2 picked my design skill, /awwwards, on its own.** It's a skill I wrote for myself, so it's not something you can install.
- Each run started in an **empty folder**, on 10 Nov 2026.

READ THE COSTS RIGHT

The dollar figures are what Claude Code reports for the session **at API list prices**. They're an estimate of the work, not what my plan billed me.

THE SHORT ANSWER

OPUS 5.5	**5.2 min · $1.51**
FABLE 5.2	**8.4 min · $3.70**
VERDICT	For a website like this, **Opus by itself is enough**

THE PROMPT

The *exact prompt* I used

Paste it once into each model, in its own empty folder. Then don't touch it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Build a website for my design studio, Halfmoon Studio. We're a
3-person studio in Pune that designs brands and websites for
small businesses.

One page with:
- a hero with our name and one line about what we do
- 6 selected projects in a grid (make the project images yourself
with CSS or SVG, no stock photos)
- our services, with prices starting at ₹25,000
- a short about section with the team
- a contact form

Make it look like a real studio's website: a strong layout,
smooth scroll animations, and real copy (no lorem ipsum). It must
work on a phone too.

Use plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript in this folder. No build step
and no libraries, except Google Fonts. When it's done, open
index.html in my browser.
```

THE RESULTS

What each model *cost*

$1.51	$3.70
Opus 5.5 · 5.2 min	Fable 5.2 · 8.4 min

PRICE PER TOKEN	Fable is **2×** Opus
MY RUN COST	Fable **2.45×** ($3.70 vs $1.51)
MY RUN TIME	Fable **1.6×** longer (8.4 vs 5.2 min)
NOT QUITE EQUAL	Fable also loaded my design skill, so the two runs didn't do identical work

At API list prices: an estimate, not a bill.



Opus 5.5 by itself: editorial serif and a half-moon mark.



Fable 5.2 with /awwwards: a dark moon hero.

THE PRICE LIST

Exactly *twice* the price

API PRICE PER MILLION TOKENS (INPUT / OUTPUT)

OPUS 5.5	**$4 / $20**
FABLE 5.2	**$8 / $40**: exactly 2× (Fable 5.1 was $10 / $50)

Anthropic's pricing page, checked 10 Nov 2026.

ON A CLAUDE PLAN

FREE	No Fable
PRO	Outside your plan's limits: it runs on paid usage credits. **Launch week** it's included (up to 50% of your weekly limit + one Fable reset) until **16 Nov 2026, 11:59 pm PT**
MAX, ULTRA	Included, up to 50% of your weekly limits
TEAM, ENTERPRISE	Standard seats work like Pro; premium seats like Max

SOURCES

1. Claude Fable and Mythos 5.2 launch post `anthropic.com`
2. Claude Fable `anthropic.com`
3. API pricing `platform.claude.com`
4. Fable models on your plan `support.claude.com`
5. Launch-week usage `support.claude.com`
6. Claude Code: choosing a model `code.claude.com`
7. Claude Code: costs and /usage `code.claude.com`

WORTH IT?

When Fable is *worth 2×*

ANTHROPIC'S OWN ADVICE

For most coding and knowledge tasks, start with **Opus 5.5**, "our strongest daily driver". Fable is "best for the most ambitious, open-ended technical work".

Use Opus 5.5 for

- Everyday builds like this website, landing pages, small apps
- Edits, fixes and anything you'll run many times a day
- Anything where a good result now beats a perfect one later

Try Fable 5.2 for

- The hardest, open-ended jobs: big builds, tricky systems
- A problem Opus has already tried and couldn't crack
- Work where one better answer is worth paying double for

MY TAKE

Opus by itself is *enough*

For a website like this one, both looked like a real studio made them. I'd keep Fable for the hard jobs.

RUN IT YOURSELF

Check the cost *yourself*

1 Update Claude Code

Fable 5.2 needs **version 2.1.321 or later**. Check with `claude --version`.

2 Run Opus first

Open Claude Code in an empty folder, type `/model opus`, paste the prompt and let it finish.

3 Read the cost

Type `/usage` (or `/cost`). It shows the session's tokens and cost **at API prices**: an estimate, not your bill. On a plan you also see your usage bars.

4 Run Fable the same way

New empty folder, `/model fable`, the same prompt, then `/usage` again. Compare the two numbers and the two sites.

BEFORE YOU SWITCH

Where Fable bills to usage credits (Pro after 16 Nov), the model menu says **"Requires usage credits"** and asks you to agree once. That's real money.



Spend *where it counts*

Opus for the everyday, Fable for the hard ones.

— Abhay